



RCCG OCEANIA

Character & Holiness

RESPONDING TO GOD'S VISION IN LIGHT

AT A GLANCE

BIG IDEA

"The Lord is showing me a vision" is not only about what is revealed—it is about how we respond. John 3:19–21 contrasts two paths: loving darkness to hide evil deeds, or coming to the light to live in truth. This study helps you examine your response to God's revelation and choose a life that can stand openly in His light.

PRIMARY PASSAGES

John 3:19

John 3:20

John 3:21

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- A vision from the Lord is an invitation to His light, not merely information.
- John 3:19 exposes the core conflict: light has come, yet many love darkness because of evil deeds.
- Avoiding the light is often driven by fear of exposure and a desire to keep deeds hidden (John 3:20).
- Coming to the light is a practical choice to do truth, allowing God to reveal what is truly at work (John 3:21).
- Walking in the light means your life can be seen without needing secrecy, because your works are done in God (John 3:21).

INTRODUCTION

When God reveals something—when the Lord shows a vision—the moment becomes a crossroads. Revelation is not only meant to inform; it calls for a response. John 3:19–21 describes two opposing movements: moving toward the light to do truth, or retreating into darkness to keep deeds hidden. This guide helps examine what happens inside the heart when light arrives, and how to respond in a way that can remain open before God.

SCRIPTURE READING

- **John 3:19** — Diagnoses the human response to God's light: light has come into the world, yet many prefer darkness because their deeds are evil.
- **John 3:20** — Explains the pattern of darkness: those who practice evil avoid the light, fearing exposure and correction.
- **John 3:21** — Shows the way forward: the one who does truth comes to the light so that it becomes clear their deeds are done in God.

KEY POINTS

1. **VISION AND THE ARRIVAL OF LIGHT** — A vision from the Lord is a form of divine revealing—God brings something into view. John 3:19 describes this revealing as light coming into the world. Light does not leave life unchanged. When light arrives, a response follows: moving toward what God is showing, or pulling away to protect what is hidden. This means spiritual insight carries responsibility. If God brings a matter into the light, the question becomes: what will be done with what has been revealed?

- Name one area where God has brought clarity (a “vision” or insight) and write what response it calls for.
- Ask: “Does this revelation lead me to transparency before God, or to self-protection?”
- Choose one concrete next step that moves you toward the light rather than delaying change.
- Pray honestly for willingness to respond, not merely to understand.

Scripture: John 3:19

2. **THE DANGER OF LOVING DARKNESS** — John 3:19 describes more than being in darkness—it speaks of loving darkness. This is a heart-level preference, not merely a lack of knowledge. The passage connects that love to deeds. Darkness becomes appealing when a person wants to keep certain actions, habits, or motives from being seen and addressed. Loving darkness is dangerous because it trains the soul to treat hiding as safety and exposure as threat—even when God’s light is meant to heal and restore.

- Identify where secrecy has become normal (private patterns, hidden compromises, double standards).
- Ask: “What am I protecting by staying in darkness?” and answer with specific deeds, not vague feelings.
- Confess to God the love of hiding wherever it exists, without excuses.
- Replace concealment with one act of openness that aligns with truth (for example, bringing a hidden choice into prayerful accountability).

Scripture: John 3:19

KEY POINTS (CONT.)

3. WHY PEOPLE AVOID EXPOSURE — John 3:20 explains the behavior that flows from darkness: the one who practices evil does not come to the light. The issue is not that the light is unclear; it is that the light exposes. Avoidance is often strategic. People withdraw from anything that might reveal what they are doing—because exposure threatens control, reputation, and cherished sin. This verse invites self-examination: when there is resistance to the light, it is wise to ask what deeds are being defended and what truth is being resisted.

- Notice where you avoid the light: dodging conviction, minimizing wrongdoing, or shifting blame.
- When you feel defensive, pause and ask: “What would the light reveal right now?”
- Stop one hiding pattern this week (for example, deleting evidence, secretive communication, or private rationalizations).
- Invite God to correct you where exposure is needed, trusting that His light is meant for restoration.

Scripture: John 3:20

4. COMING TO THE LIGHT BY DOING TRUTH — John 3:21 presents a different way to live: doing truth and coming to the light. Truth here is not merely something to agree with; it is something to practice. Coming to the light is not self-display. The purpose is that it becomes evident what is truly happening—deeds shown to be done in God, not powered by manipulation, secrecy, or self-glory. This is a life that can be examined. The direction is toward openness before God, where actions align with what God desires and where God receives the credit for what is good.

- Define one “truth” you must do (not merely believe) and put it into practice in a specific relationship or decision.
- Choose transparency: act in ways you could openly place before God’s light without needing a hidden explanation.
- When you do good, consciously acknowledge dependence on God so that your deeds are “done in God.”
- Build a habit of daily self-examination: “What did I do in darkness today, and what did I bring into the light?”

Scripture: John 3:21

GROUP DISCUSSION

Tip: Use these questions to guide the group from seeing → understanding → applying.

OBSERVATION

- According to John 3:19–21, what has come into the world, and what are the two different responses to it?
- What reasons are given for why people love darkness rather than light (John 3:19)?
- What does John 3:20 say people fear will happen if they come to the light?
- In John 3:21, what does the person who “does truth” do, and what becomes evident about their deeds?
- List the repeated themes in these verses (light, darkness, truth, deeds). What contrasts stand out?

INTERPRETATION

- What does it mean to treat a vision or revelation from God as an invitation rather than mere information?
- How does “loving darkness” differ from simply being unaware or uninformed (John 3:19)?
- Why might exposure feel threatening even when God’s light is meant to bring life and correction (John 3:20)?
- What do you think “doing truth” includes beyond correct beliefs (John 3:21)?
- What does it imply that deeds can be shown to be “done in God” (John 3:21)?

APPLICATION

- Where is there a temptation to manage appearances rather than come into the light? What deeds are being protected?
- What is one practical step you can take to stop avoiding exposure and instead move toward the light?
- When you sense resistance to the light, what questions can you ask to locate what you are trying to hide?
- How can a group cultivate a culture where coming to the light is normal and truth is practiced?
- What would change this week if you lived as though everything could be brought into God's light without fear?

PRAYER FOCUS

- Lord, give me grace to respond to Your vision by coming into the light, not retreating into darkness.
- Expose and heal any love of secrecy in me; bring my deeds into truth through confession and repentance.
- Replace fear of exposure with trust in Your goodness, correction, and restoration.
- Empower me to do truth daily so my deeds are shown to be done in God.

NEXT STEP

Identify one area God has brought into the light, confess what needs confessing, and take one concrete action of truth and transparency before God and a trusted believer.

CONCLUSION

A vision from the Lord calls for a decision. John 3:19–21 places every person in the same light: either to love darkness and protect hidden deeds, or to do truth and come into the light. The path forward is not perfection on display, but honesty before God—living openly so that what is done can be shown to be done in God. Choose the light, practice truth, and let God’s revealing lead to a transformed life.